The Second Coming

***Purpose**: To show that the second coming of Christ is the pinnacle of salvation history and that it is literal, visible, audible and POWERFUL.*

***Centred on**: Jesus is coming to restore to deliver and to make an end of sin, pain and death.*

John 17:24… Jesus' desire for us is to be re-united with Him. [*Immanuel]* God wants to be *with us.*

John 14:1-3… Jesus is coming again to *receive you unto Himself.* The 2nd Coming is ***Personal*** it's not an event but a person. It's not just to receive a group of people but to receive you.

Titus 2:13… Apostles anticipated & taught the 2nd coming of Jesus. Jesus preached the 2nd coming and the apostles preached it as well. [*looking*] signifies an action, is it important what we look for? **Matt 24:23-26**. Satan seeks to lead people to misunderstand and misinterpret the 2nd coming; he doesn't want you to be a part of God's kingdom, because he'll never be. Grace is given for Salvation, Recreation transforms us…we are being recreated know to be ready for his appearing.

Heb 9:28… **Q:** Why is Jesus coming? To bring about the full plan of Salvation to it's completion. It's God's rescue plan. *Here is how it will unfold…*

Literal: Acts 1:9-11… *'Watched', 'sight', 'looked', 'gazing', 'saw'* → '*this same* [literal] *Jesus…' (Luke 24:39)*

Visible: Rev 1:7… *Inclusive,* not exclusive. Every person will see the coming of Christ.

"Behold, he is coming"- **ἔρχομαι** [erchomai /er·khom·ahee/] Middle voice of a primary verb (used only in the present and imperfect tenses).

Here John announces the theme of the Revelation. The second coming of Christ is the goal toward which all else moves forward. Significantly, he uses the present tense (he cometh/ KJV), thereby stressing the certainty of the event, perhaps also with a sense of its imminence.

Audible: 1 Thes 4:13-17… The noise created from all these instruments awakens the dead from their sleep. Evident that the 2nd coming is not *silent or secret.*

Physical: 1 Cor 15:51-55… **(Phil 3:20-21).** It is only at the 2nd coming that we receive immortal life. We will be victorious over death because Jesus was victorious over death.

Climactic: Rev 6:14-17… God purpose at His second coming is not to destroy but to reclaim those who have trusted in Him throughout the ages. He is coming back for them *not* the wicked. He comes forth calling the righteous and it's this pure voice that causes the wicked to tremble. (Joel 3:16) To save those who have hide in the cleft of the rock.

Glorious: Matt 25:31… He is emptying heaven, to get *you.* 1 angel caused 100 soldiers to fall down as dead men, how about ten thousand times ten thousand. This text now reaffirms that not only will Jesus present with his angels, but "ALL" the angels.

Inevitable but timing is unknown: Ps 50:3-4, Matt 24:36… We don't know when but we are given signs to see when it will be.

Personal: Rev 21:4… Re-united with God. The ultimate purpose that God has been working towards for thousands of years is finally realized.

Matt 24:42-44 …Emphasis '*be ready.'* We can be ready if we 1. Accept Jesus & 2. Understand how His rescue plan will unfold.

Objections:

The secret Rapture;

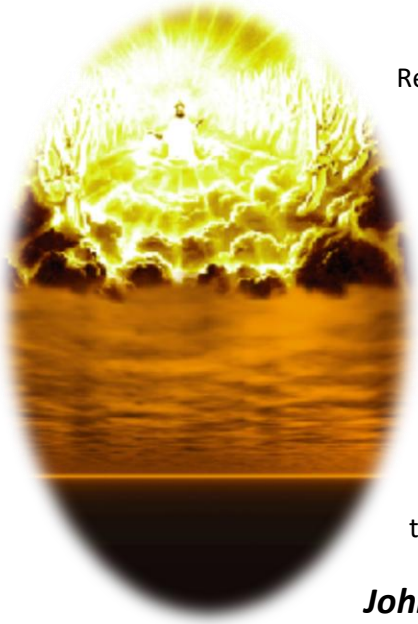
The secret rapture is a belief that Jesus will return secretly and rapture away the saved, leaving behind those whom are not following Christ in order for them to have to live through the last seven year tribulation period and in essence allowing them a "second chance." Some texts associated with this view are as follows:

Matthew 24: 37-39… Notice how Jesus is drawing a parallel with the story of Noah to define the second coming. Here he describes how the flood came and "**took**" them all away, then immediately moves into a similar exposition of Luke's analogy of the coming of the Lord in which two will be in the field and one will be "**taken**" and one will be left. We know that the people taken by the flood were not taken to salvation but rather to destruction. The term "taken" that is so often used to support the theory of the secret rapture is actually consistent with that of destruction rather than bliss!

Luke 17:34-37… This text is often misapplied as to believe that the ones whom are taken are taken to heaven and those whom are left are left on earth. If we keep reading, verse 37 clarifies the destiny of those that are "taken." (Taken to destruction).

Genesis 7: 21-23… Notice the wording used in verse 23, remained is just another way of saying left behind. So it is people that are left behind that are on the right path, not the ones taken away. Here we find the Bible suggests a complete reversal of a theology which has been made popular by the author Hal Lindsey and his "left behind" theory.

1 Thessalonians 4: 16-17… Notice here again the use of the word "remain." It is clear that we want to be in the group that are left behind and not in the group that are taken away.



Remember, the origin of the secret rapture is based on "taking" certain people away from the earth and leaving others here to live through the seven year "tribulation" period. From cover to cover you will not find any evidence from the Bible as to a seven year tribulation period. There is mention of tribulation however, and the theory of the secret rapture may have been instigated as to soften the minds of people in order to maintain church attendance. Some Biblical examples of tribulation are as follows:

Acts 14: 22… Here we find the apostle Paul confirming to the faith of believers, that WE must enter the kingdom THROUGH tribulation.

John16: 33… Jesus confirms that WE WILL GO THROUGH TRIBULATION, but assures us that he has overcome the world.

2 Peter 3: 10; 1 Thes 5:2 [3-4,6]…This text is referring to the "timing" not the manner of his return. This is clearly evident in mentioning of a great noise and the elements melting with fervent heat.

The danger of believing in the secret rapture prior to the tribulation is the second chance theory that is associated. We all need to accept Jesus today, and allow him to transform our lives in a way that only he knows how. We can do very little of our self, but with him all things are possible. (**Philippians 4: 13; 2 Corinthians 6: 2**).

, 2 Pet 3:10 'thief'

→ ***Rev 3:3, 16:15…*** (*it is a thief to those who aren't watching… the event isn't a thief, for it is loud and known. The timing of the event is what comes as a thief.)*

- The second coming is a surprise only to the unprepared, not to those who are prepared
- Doesn't say that the Lord will come as a thief but the day will be as a thief

- *…."The 144,000 shouted, Hallelujah! as they recognized their friends who had been torn from them by death, and in the same moment we were changed and caught up together with them to meet the Lord in the air. We all entered the cloud together, and were seven days ascending to the sea of glass, when Jesus brought along the crowns and with his own right hand placed them on our heads"…*
- ***Spiritual Gifts, Volume 2. Seventh-day Adventist Publishing Association, 1858; 2002, S.33***

Book- Francis D Nichol , Answers to Objections